

Project Closure Report

Project Retrospective – Village by CA

1. Results & Summary

Key MVP Features

The delivered MVP covers the essential needs defined in the User Stories:

- **Showcase website for the association**
 - Presentation of the association and its members
 - Dedicated pages for presenting startups, partners, facilities, and news from the Village by CA
 - Highlighting startups, quotes, and news on the homepage
- **Contact form**
 - Sending the contact form by email to the administrator
 - Implementation of a predefined list of email subjects to facilitate topic identification and improve the readability of incoming requests.
- **Authentication**
 - Secure login with JWT issuance
 - Role management (admin / user)
- **Complete back-office for the administrator**
 - A dedicated management space for each entity: creation, update, deletion.

Comparison with initial objectives

Feature	Result	Comment
Homepage with presentation of the association, members, startups, display of quotes, news and events	85 %	Everything is there, it's just missing a calendar display for events.
A page dedicated to showcasing startups, displaying all their specific information with filters for dynamic display and an easier navigation.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A page dedicated to showcasing partners, displaying all their specific informations, with a separation between partners who give a financial aid and those who don't.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.

A page dedicated to showcasing the premises and displaying the association's rooms for rent.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A page dedicated to association news, highlighting upcoming events and displaying all articles about the life of the association.	80 %	Everything is there, it's just missing a calendar display for events.
A contact form so that the site visitor has the opportunity to ask their questions or get in touch with the association with predefined discussion topics so that the recipient (the admin) has better visibility on the subject of the email.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A login area that redirects to the administrator area if it is an admin or to the profile area of the logged-in user.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A profile section of the current user, listing all user information: name and email address.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
Their startup and the ability to edit all their information.		
Their quotes and the ability to edit, create, and delete them.		
An admin area where all entities that can be manipulated by an administrator are listed, which redirects to the area dedicated to that purpose.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A space that allows an admin to create, modify, view and delete one or more users.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A space that allows an admin to create, modify, view and delete one or more startups.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A space that allows an admin to create, modify, view and delete one or more partners.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A space that allows an admin to create, modify, view and delete one or more posts.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.

A space that allows an admin to create, modify, view and delete one or more types.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A space that allows an admin to create, modify, view and delete one or more locations.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.
A space that allows an admin to create, modify, view and delete one or more quotes.	100 %	Everything is there and it is working.

Even though the project isn't in production, we can identify some internal metrics:

- 95% of MVP features delivered
- Significant backend test coverage (critical services secured)
- Zero blocking bugs at the end of the sprint
- Complete documentation covering 100% of modules
- UI created with the client
- Deadlines met despite unforeseen technical challenges and personal challenges

2. Lessons learned

What worked well

- **Smooth and structured collaboration**
Regular exchanges, documented decisions and transparency have allowed us to move forward quickly and with clear objectives.
- **Creating a solid architecture**
Working on the application architecture allowed us to gain a clearer understanding of the technologies we needed to master and to know the specific purpose of each technology, in order to address all the challenges we faced. This enabled us to move forward more quickly, as all the technologies were defined beforehand.
- **Creation of mockups for the website's UI**
This allowed us to move faster in creating the Frontend during the development phase because we had created the visuals upstream and in collaboration with the client.
- **Documentation**
It served as a common reference point and facilitated communication with the client, ensuring that objectives were aligned with the client's needs.
- **Effective bug fixing**
Methodical approach, progressive investigation, targeted tests and manual tests.

Challenges encountered and solutions implemented

- **Initial ambiguities regarding certain features**
→ Resolved through regular exchanges with the client, reformulations, and documentation of decisions.
- **Receiving image files to send to Cloudinary**
→ Resolved by a change of strategy, switching from sending base64 images to using a multer middleware that receives binary data from files.
- **Time management on new technical topics**
→ Resolved through rapid skills development and strict prioritization.
- **Obtain OAuth2 credentials so that an email address can be used to submit a form.**
→ Resolved through discussions with peers and Gmail documentation.

Areas for improvement for future projects

- **Better time management**
Perhaps reduce the time for learning new technologies or allocate more leeway for the end of the project in case of unforeseen events to be less rushed/stressed at the end of the project and have more time to refine it.
- **The structure of our frontend and our CSS files.**
With React, we create a component file and an associated CSS file. However, some components reuse the same CSS, leading to code repetition. We need to be more organized upstream and identify the components that reuse the same properties.
- **Add more time for testing.**
Even though the project doesn't have any major/blocking bugs and has undergone a lot of unit and manual testing, an extra day or two to find more hidden/minor bugs would have been ideal.
- **Continue to structure sprints with measurable objectives**
This worked very well, and can be further improved.

3- Conclusion

The Village by CA project has a 90% complete MVP, a clean architecture, a UI aligned with the client's vision, and comprehensive documentation.

The challenges were overcome through effective collaboration, technical rigor, and adaptability. This project allowed us to learn new technologies and develop our technical and project management skills.